

Great question ✓💡 — and the answer is **VERY important** when using anchor-positioning or any overlay animation.

Let me explain **exactly WHY** `pointer-events: none;` matters *so much* for your animation.

## ★ 1. Because your `.pointer` element sits **ON TOP** of the `.box`

You made `.pointer` absolutely positioned:

CSS

```
.pointer {  
  position: absolute;  
  top: anchor(top);  
  left: anchor(left);  
  right: anchor(right);  
  bottom: anchor(bottom);  
}
```

So when you hover a `.box`, the `.pointer` moves to cover that box.

Without `pointer-events: none`

The pointer physically blocks your mouse → you stop hovering the box.

## ★ 2. When hover breaks, the anchor disappears → animation breaks

This part in your code:

CSS

```
.box:hover {  
  anchor-name: --select-target;  
}
```

Anchor is created **ONLY** during `:hover`.

So:

✗ As soon as the `.pointer` covers the box

→ the mouse is touching the pointer,

→ NOT touching the box anymore,

- hover stops,
- anchor disappears,
- pointer jumps back,
- hover starts again,
- anchor appears...

This creates an **infinite loop of flickering** like this:

- ➡ hover starts
- ➡ pointer moves
- ➡ pointer blocks hover
- ➡ hover stops
- ➡ pointer resets

🔥 This is why the animation looks broken.

### ★ 3. Adding `pointer-events: none;` fixes the flicker

Because now:

- ✓ Mouse goes **THROUGH** the pointer
- ✓ You stay hovered on the `.box`
- ✓ The anchor stays active
- ✓ The pointer smoothly follows
- ✓ No breaking, no flickering, no jump-back

This is **EXACTLY** why the animation works once `pointer-events: none` is added.

### 🎯 The simple truth

Your animation relies on this logic:

SCSS

`:hover` → creates anchor → moves pointer → pointer must not kill hover

`pointer-events: none;` ensures that the pointer **never kills the hover**, so the animation stays active.

### ★ Visual Explanation

| Situation               | Without pointer-events           | With pointer-events                      |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Hover <code>.box</code> | pointer appears and blocks mouse | pointer appears but mouse passes through |
| Anchor active?          | ✗ breaks instantly               | ✓ stays active                           |
| Animation smooth?       | ✗ flickers                       | ✓ smooth                                 |
| Hover stable?           | ✗ unstable                       | ✓ stable                                 |



## So in your animation:

`pointer-events: none;` is required for stable anchor-hover animation.



**Want me to rewrite your code so anchor works without relying on hover?**

I can make it use:

- ✓ `:has()` selector
- ✓ `data-active` attributes
- ✓ JS-free stable anchor

Just tell me!